

Nether biome surface builder types incorrectly assume the world height is 128 blocks

[MC-187716](#) CUSTOM WORLDS

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	1.16 Pre-release 2; 1.16 Release Candidate 1; 1.16; 1.16.1; 20w27a; 20w28a; 1.16.2 Pre-release 1; 1.16.2 Pre-release 3; 1.16.2; 1.16.4; 20w46a; 20w48a; 20w49a; 20w51a; 21w03a; 1.16.5 Release Candidate 1; 1.16.5; 21w05a; 21w06a; 21w07a; 21w08a; 21w08b; 21w10a; 21w11a; 21w13a; 21w14a; 21w15a; 21w16a (+more)
Fixed in	21w44a
Reported	2020-06-05
Mojira category	Custom Worlds

REPRODUCTION TARGET

Use version: 1.16 Pre-release 2

Affected versions (35):

1.16 Pre-release 2

1.16 Release Candidate 1

1.16

1.16.1

20w27a

20w28a

1.16.2 Pre-release 1

1.16.2 Pre-release 3

1.16.2

1.16.4

20w46a

20w48a

20w49a

20w51a

21w03a

1.16.5 Release Candidate 1

1.16.5

21w05a

21w06a

21w07a

21w08a

21w08b

21w10a

21w11a

21w13a

21w14a

21w15a

21w16a

21w17a

21w18a

21w20a

1.17 Pre-release 2

1.17 Release Candidate 1

21w42a

21w43a

Environment:

Minecraft: Java Edition 1.16 Pre-release 2 in single-player, using a fresh custom world imported from the report's version-compatible world-generation JSON. Use an unmodified client, Creative mode, commands enabled, and Spectator mode for non-destructive inspection. Use an isolated game directory so the pre-release does not access unrelated worlds.

PRECONDITIONS

- The Minecraft Launcher can start the exact affected version 1.16 Pre-release 2; do not substitute 1.16 Release Candidate 1, release 1.16, or fix version 21w44a.
- Download the MC-187716 attachment named worldgen_settings_export.json and keep its contents unchanged. The plan assumes this is the early attachment intended for the initial 1.16 Pre-release reproduction.
- Before continuing, establish that the selected JSON defines a Nether whose generated terrain can extend above Y=127. If the file is rejected by 1.16 Pre-release 2 or does not define a taller Nether, stop rather than silently replacing or rewriting it.
- Create a completely new world in 1.16 Pre-release 2. Do not reuse a world opened in 1.16 Pre-release 1, and do not upgrade the test world to another version.
- Do not enable unrelated data packs, mods, or custom world-generation files.
- The instructions refer to the default keyboard and mouse controls. If controls are rebound, use the bound control for the same action.

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1 VERIFIED

In the Minecraft Launcher, create or select an installation for the exact affected version 1.16 Pre-release 2 and launch it from an isolated game directory. Enable historical snapshot/pre-release versions in the launcher if the version is not initially listed.

INPUT Version: 1.16-pre2

SUCCESS CUE The Minecraft title screen is open and identifies the running game as Minecraft 1.16 Pre-release 2.

2 REPORT

Make the report attachment worldgen_settings_export.json available through the operating system's file chooser. Do not rename its extension, edit its JSON, or substitute either Taller Nether ZIP attachment, because those ZIP files were discussed for later snapshots.

INPUT worldgen_settings_export.json

SUCCESS CUE An unchanged local copy of worldgen_settings_export.json is available for selection.

3 INFERRED

From the title screen, select Singleplayer and then Create New World. This must be a new world rather than a re-created or converted older save.

INPUT Singleplayer -> Create New World

SUCCESS CUE The Create New World screen is open for a new save.

4 VERIFIED

Open More World Options and select Import Settings. In the file chooser, select worldgen_settings_export.json. Accept the experimental custom-world warning if one appears. Do not manually alter any imported generator, dimension, height, default-block, biome, or surface-builder value.

INPUT More World Options... -> Import Settings -> worldgen_settings_export.json

SUCCESS CUE Minecraft accepts the JSON and returns to world creation with the imported custom world-generation settings active; no invalid-settings or data-pack error is displayed.

5 INFERRED

Set the world to Creative mode so commands and flight-related setup are available without gathering resources. Ensure Allow Cheats is ON after importing the settings, because importing may return the interface to a different world-creation state.

INPUT Game Mode: Creative; Allow Cheats: ON

SUCCESS CUE The world-creation screen shows Creative mode and commands/cheats enabled.

6 INFERRED

Optionally give the world a recognizable name, then select Create New World. Do not change the imported world-generation options before creating it.

INPUT World Name: MC-187716 1.16-pre2; Create New World

SUCCESS CUE World creation begins using the imported settings.

7 **INFERRED**

Wait for the player to enter the new world. Do not continue while the loading screen is visible or while nearby chunks are still appearing. Test movement briefly to confirm that the integrated server is responsive.

SUCCESS CUE The player is present in the newly created world, nearby terrain is rendered, and movement responds normally.

8 **INFERRED**

Enter Spectator mode so the player can inspect tall Nether terrain without mining, suffocating, falling, or modifying naturally generated surfaces. Press T to open chat, enter the command including its leading slash, and press Enter.

INPUT `/gamemode spectator`

SUCCESS CUE The command succeeds; the hotbar disappears and the player can fly through solid blocks.

9 **INFERRED**

Teleport into the custom Nether at Y=160. Press T, enter the command exactly with the leading slash, and press Enter. Spectator mode makes the initial destination safe even if the coordinate is inside solid terrain or above an open cavern.

INPUT `/execute in minecraft:the_nether run teleport @s 0 160 0`

SUCCESS CUE The view reloads in the Nether dimension and the player remains in Spectator mode near Y=160.

10 **INFERRED**

Wait until the Nether terrain surrounding the destination has rendered and movement and chat respond normally. Then press F3, or Fn+F3 on keyboards where the function row is media-controlled, to open the debug overlay.

INPUT `F3`

SUCCESS CUE The debug overlay is visible, the current dimension is minecraft:the_nether, and the displayed player Y coordinate is approximately 160.

11 **REPORT**

Locate a biome whose affected surface-builder type is explicitly confirmed by the report. While still near Y=160, press T, enter the Soul Sand Valley locate command with its leading slash, and press Enter.

INPUT `/locatebiome minecraft:soul_sand_valley`

SUCCESS CUE Chat returns coordinates for a nearby minecraft:soul_sand_valley instead of reporting that the biome could not be found.

12 **INFERRED** **TRIGGER**

Read the X and Z coordinates returned by locatebiome. Press T and teleport to those X and Z coordinates while retaining Y=160. Replace only the two placeholders; keep the command's Y value at 160. This loads or generates tall Nether terrain at the vertical level relevant to the report.

INPUT `/teleport @s <RETURNED_X> 160 <RETURNED_Z>`

SUCCESS CUE The teleport completes and the player is positioned at Y=160 near the located Soul Sand Valley coordinates.

13 **INFERRED**

Do not move immediately after teleporting. Wait until all nearby chunks have rendered and movement, the debug overlay, and chat update normally.

SUCCESS CUE The terrain around the located coordinates is fully rendered and the integrated server is responsive.

14 **INFERRED**

Use the F3 biome line to verify that the player's current position at Y greater than 127 is inside `minecraft:soul_sand_valley`. If the exact teleport point is on a biome boundary, move horizontally in Spectator mode near the returned coordinates while keeping Y above 127 until the biome line identifies `minecraft:soul_sand_valley`. If the biome cannot be reached at this height, repeat the locate command from the current Y=160 position and use the new X and Z result.

INPUT F3 biome check: `minecraft:soul_sand_valley`

SUCCESS CUE The debug overlay identifies the current biome as `minecraft:soul_sand_valley` while the player's Y coordinate remains greater than 127.

15 **INFERRED**

Within the confirmed Soul Sand Valley, use Spectator flight to locate naturally generated solid terrain above Y=127. Use the movement controls W/A/S/D, Space to ascend, and Left Shift to descend. Look specifically for an exposed floor surface: a solid top block with air directly above it, rather than an arbitrary block inside a solid mass. Do not break or place blocks.

INPUT W/A/S/D; Space; Left Shift

SUCCESS CUE A naturally generated exposed floor surface in `minecraft:soul_sand_valley` is visible, and the F3 targeted-block coordinates place its top block at Y=128 or higher.

16 **INFERRED**

Hover two to five blocks above the selected surface, center it in view, and stop all movement. Keep the F3 overlay open so the dimension, biome, player height, and targeted-block coordinates remain available. Wait until chunk rendering and movement are stable, then hand control to the observation subsystem without changing versions or modifying the terrain.

SUCCESS CUE A stable, naturally generated Soul Sand Valley floor surface at Y=128 or higher is centered in view, `minecraft:the_nether` and `minecraft:soul_sand_valley` are visible in debug information, and the game is responsive.

HANDOFF TO OBSERVATION

The custom Nether chunk near the located Soul Sand Valley has been generated or loaded at Y=160, and the player is now stationary in Spectator mode above a naturally generated Soul Sand Valley floor surface whose top block is at Y=128 or higher. The F3 overlay remains open and the terrain has not been modified. Begin surface-composition observation now.

UNCERTAINTIES

- The raw contents and attachment timestamps were not supplied. The plan assumes `worldgen_settings_export.json` is the attachment compatible with the first listed affected version, 1.16 Pre-release 2. If Minecraft rejects it, attachment metadata or contents are required before a valid first-version reproduction can continue.
- The report supplies no deterministic world seed or Nether coordinates. The `locatebiome` command and limited high-altitude Spectator search are therefore necessary practical inferences.
- The report confirms `minecraft:nether_forest`, `minecraft:soul_sand_valley`, and `minecraft:basalt_deltas` surface-builder types. This plan selects `minecraft:soul_sand_valley` as one confirmed test case and does not use the only tentatively identified `minecraft:nether` type.
- The report does not provide a formal numbered Steps to Reproduce section. The minimum path of importing a taller-Nether configuration, generating Nether chunks above $Y=127$, and positioning the player at a confirmed affected biome surface was reconstructed from the description, comments, and attachment names.
- Web verification confirmed that the affected release family exposed experimental custom-world import during world creation and that a fresh 1.16 Pre-release 2 world should be used rather than a world opened in 1.16 Pre-release 1. Command-based navigation and biome selection remain practical implementation choices rather than report-mandated actions.

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Trigger reached?	YES / NO
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	